will store sessions using the cache implementation you have configured for your application. The advantage of this is that you can use your existing cache infrastructure for storing sessions without requiring any additional setup or administration. The downside, of course, is that the sessions will be ephemeral and could disappear at any time.

Read more about session storage in the Security Guide.

If you need a different session storage mechanism, you can change it in the `config/initializers/session_store.rb` file:

```
# Use the database for sessions instead of the cookie-based default,
# which shouldn't be used to store highly confidential information
# (create the session table with "rails g
active_record:session_migration")
# Rails.application.config.session_store :active_record_store
```

Rails sets up a session key (the name of the cookie) when signing the session data. These can also be changed in `config/initializers/session_store.rb`:

```
# Be sure to restart your server when you modify this file.
Rails.application.config.session_store :cookie_store, key:
'_your_app_session'
```

You can also pass a `:domain` key and specify the domain name for the cookie:

```
# Be sure to restart your server when you modify this file.
Rails.application.config.session_store :cookie_store, key:
'_your_app_session', domain: ".example.com"
```

Rails sets up (for the CookieStore) a secret key used for signing the session data. This can be changed in `config/secrets.yml`

```
# Be sure to restart your server when you modify this file.

# Your secret key is used for verifying the integrity of signed
cookies.
# If you change this key, all old signed cookies will become invalid!

# Make sure the secret is at least 30 characters and all random,
# no regular words or you'll be exposed to dictionary attacks.
# You can use `rake secret` to generate a secure secret key.

# Make sure the secrets in this file are kept private
# if you're sharing your code publicly.

development:
  secret_key_base: a75d...

test:
  secret_key_base: 492f...

# Do not keep production secrets in the repository,
# instead read values from the environment.
production:
  secret_key_base: <%= ENV["SECRET_KEY_BASE"] %>
```

Changing the secret when using the `CookieStore` will invalidate all existing sessions.

5.1 Accessing the Session

In your controller you can access the session through the `session` instance method.

Sessions are lazily loaded. If you don't access sessions in your action's code, they will not be loaded. Hence you will never need to disable sessions, just not accessing them will do the job.

Session values are stored using key/value pairs like a hash:

```
class ApplicationController < ActionController::Base
```